

Troy Ascher

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EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Information Systems

May 2022

Boston University

3.8 GPA, Business Intelligence and Database Management Specialization

Bachelor of Science(hons), International Business and Chinese Language

July 2020

The University of Liverpool / Xi'an Jiaotong – Liverpool University

Suzhou, China

2:1 Upper second-class honors, merit scholarship awardee

Associate of Science, Management Information Systems

December 2016

Saint Paul College

St. Paul, MN, USA

4.0 GPA, Dean's list

SKILLS

- R, SQL (SQL Server/T-SQL), Python, Git, Visual Studio, Visio, Excel; limited use of VBA
- Database schema design, normalization, and query optimization
- Datawarehouse design and implementation using Kimball method
- Data mining and machine learning using WEKA and SAP JMP
- ETL using Python, Visual Studio, SQL, and R
- Data visualization using RStudio and Jupyter notebooks; familiar with Power BI and Tableau
- Coursework in data mining, machine learning using WEKA, JMP
- Cross-cultural communication: worked daily with team members in China, England, India, and the USA
- Languages: Native English and basic Mandarin Chinese

EXPERIENCE

Sr. HRIS Analyst

July 2015 - May 2017

Ameriprise Financial Inc.

Minneapolis, MN

- Managed customization requests for Peoplesoft HCM and CRM modules
- Gathered and wrote business requirements on more than twenty technical projects
- Wrote and executed test cases, completed UAT on behalf of business partners
- Coordinated an 8-month annual payroll-year-end project while adhering to PMBOK best practices
- Managed system interfaces between HR systems and external vendors using Toad for Oracle SQL database
- Managed the design and implementation of Oracle (SQL) database interfaces
- Built strong relationships in a diverse work environment: 50% India, 40% USA, 10% in England

Recruiting Coordinator and HR Technology Representative

October 2013 - June 2015

Caribou Coffee Company

Minneapolis, MN

- Recruited candidates in both high-volume retail and warehouse environments
- Managed user profiles and troubleshoot end-user issues in the applicant tracking system
- Compiled and implemented manager training on recruiting best practices
- Organized and executed job fairs to generate applicant flow
- Miscellaneous HR functions

HR Benefits and Technology Representative, Shift Supervisor

August 2010 - October 2013

Caribou Coffee Company

Minneapolis, MN

- Assisted team members with benefit inquiries
- Utilized Microsoft products to streamline department processes
- Created a reference library for common benefit inquiries in Microsoft Word
- Created and executed department reward and recognition program
- Received "MelonHead Award" from CEO for showing compassion and empathy to team members during the unexpected closing of 400 units
- Managed, trained, and supervised daily operations for twenty-four team members

PROJECTS

Portfolio, www.troyascher.com – **Rstudio, HTML, Git, RMarkdown**

Created an online portfolio using Git and RMarkdown in RStudio.

“NBA Data Warehouse Star Schema”, *Boston University*, individual work – **Python, Visual Studio, SQL Server**

Built a functional data warehouse with a single star-schema centered on a 700,000+ record fact table. Data was scraped from multiple data sources (Wikipedia, NBA.com, and Kaggle) using the Kaggle API. An ETL pipeline was built using python and T-SQL. The data pipeline ended in Tableau with multiple visualizations.

“Machine Learning Classification Project”, *Boston University*, student individual work -- **WEKA**

Completed a ML classification project comparing attribute selection and classification algorithms to correctly identify patients with arthritis. The best fit (75.25% weighted true positive on the test set) was obtained using a correlation attribute selection method and a logistic/neural network classification algorithm.

“Doogie Howser System”, *Boston University*, student individual work -- **Python**

Designed and implemented a program in Python to save, track, and analyze user-inputted health and wellness data. Code available at: <https://www.troy.ascher.com/DoogieHowserProject.html>

Health and Wellness Database, *Boston University*, student individual work -- **SQL**

Designed and implemented a normalized (BCNF) database for storing and retrieving health data enabling patients and doctors to easily exchange information.

Bachelor’s thesis, *Xi’an Jiaotong – Liverpool University*, “National culture and knowledge transfer: the effects of culture as measured by the GLOBE project dimensions on the efficiency of knowledge transfer in micro-foundational transactions.”

Received first-class honors on a research project to better understand the relationship between culture and knowledge transfer. Chose a qualitative research method (survey) and designed a survey to gather and analyze data points from more than 300 survey participants.

Payroll year-end reconciliation, *Ameriprise Financial*, team of ~40

Coordinated the yearly payroll year-end tax and reconciliation project two times. The role involved gathering and updating requirements, assembling a project plan using Microsoft Project, running weekly meetings with key team leaders, and supporting the team in any way necessary to ensure no deadlines were missed.

Knowledge repository, *Ameriprise Financial*, team of 5

Designed and catalogued SOP documentation to minimize knowledge loss due to future turnover. Identified areas of risk, ensured SOPs were documented, and entered the SOP into the system.

CRM and HCM security re-design: data governance, *Ameriprise Financial*, team of 1

Restructured enterprise-wide security protocols for PeopleSoft CRM and HCM, which included auditing security roles and permission, restricting access based on business needs, and ensuring that the new protocols were SOX compliant.

HR call tracking system, *Caribou Coffee*, team of 1

Identified a key area of risk for the business (no record of phone calls), petitioned management for resources to implement a system, sourced a software package, worked with IT on the installation, and trained the HR department on the system’s use.

Knowledge library, *Caribou Coffee*, team of 3

Identified the need for a central repository of policies and procedures related to benefits and leave of absence. Spearheaded the creation of a system for the benefits team to use that contained complete and up-to-date information and ensured that each employee was getting consistent information.

VOLUNTEERING & EXTRA-CURRICULARS

Troy’s Bikes, restored and marketed around 30 classic bicycles in a three-year period

Mandarin Chinese, Passed HSK level 3, currently studying for level 4

Music, assisted my church with music each week by playing guitar and singing on the worship team

Teaching, taught English to adult language learners through the Minneapolis Public School system

Finance Team, part of a four-person team that managed a quarter-million-dollar church budget